

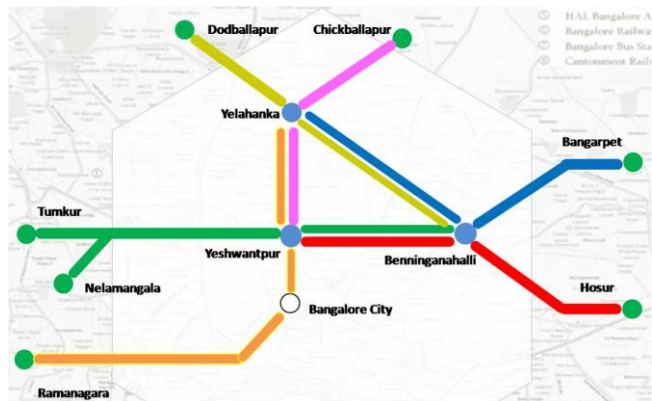
BENGALURU COMMUTER RAIL SERVICE

Provisioning mass transport for the growing economy has become a priority. With the kind of visibility Bengaluru has in the international arena and the role India is going to play in the world of the future, it is important for both central and state governments to sit up and take notice. Ignoring the long term mass transport needs of the city can backfire on the country. The economy of any city thrives on availability of good quality labor at affordable cost. Expensive housing and increased travel times only put more pressure on productivity of human capital. This may ultimately lead to flight of capital and hurt the economy with cascading effect.

Housing has already become unaffordable in Bengaluru for the lower and middle classes which is going to form a major portion of the workforce of the future. The industrial areas around Bengaluru lie close to the existing Indian Railways tracks and are being wasted as a viable mass transit option. No amount of connectivity within the city will be successful if that connectivity is not supplemented by mass transit to these industrial clusters. The key is **frequent, low cost connectivity** which can be achieved by utilizing and enhancing the existing train tracks between Bengaluru and these growth centers. Multiple reports over 27 years including RITES surveys have confirmed this fact.

This Commuter Rail Service for Bengaluru on the lines of MRVC, Mumbai & MMTS, Hyderabad will require the following

1. Setting up a **Special Purpose Vehicle** between representative entities of the Indian Railways and the Government of Karnataka, possibly executed on PPP basis
2. Introduce **new trains** on new routes and **increase the frequency** on all routes
3. **Increase capacity** of tracks and implement state of the art signaling systems
4. Build **new stations** with good quality infrastructure and **improve accessibility** to existing stations with last mile connectivity
5. Create multimodal **hubs and interchanges** to allow people to change to other modes of transport



The benefits of the Commuter Rail Service is multifold

1. At least 50 lakh people and multiple Industrial areas can be covered by existing 200+ kms of railway tracks
2. Availability of labor for growth of the already established economic ecosystem
3. Decongestion of the city & increased efficiency in commute times
4. Affordable housing for lower & middle classes
5. Significantly lower capital expenditure on provisioning mass transit by sharing Railway infrastructure

The Call to Action report prepared by Praja.in provides a citizens perspective of a quickly implementable, viable alternative. The report lays out the need and urgency of running full fledged commuter trains under a dedicated SPV set up for this purpose.

